data privacy and security, and introduces dependencies. Other external influences can further complicate these factors.

It's unsurprising that the race to build comparable open source LLMs is growing more competitive every day. As a result, there are now open source LLMs that may be adequate for numerous tasks and agent systems. There have even been so many advances in tooling in just a year that hosting LLMs locally is now very easy, as we'll see in the next section.

2.2.1 Installing and running LM Studio

LM Studio is a free download that supports downloading and hosting LLMs and other models locally for Windows, Mac, and Linux. The software is easy to use and offers several helpful features to get you started quickly. Here is a quick summary of steps to download and set up LM Studio:

1. Download LM Studio from https://lmstudio.ai/.
2. After downloading, install the software per your operating system. Be aware that some versions of LM Studio may be in beta and require installation of additional tools or libraries.
3. Launch the software.

Figure 2.3 shows the LM Studio window running. From there, you can review the current list of hot models, search for others, and even download. The home page content can be handy for understanding the details and specifications of the top models.